

Northstar Service source pack

All Northstar Service names, policies and values are synthetic training material. They are not a claim about a real company or a Microsoft tenant.

Executive context

Northstar Service is a fictional service organisation. Its leadership is considering a 30-seat Microsoft 365 Copilot pilot. No real customer records are included. The CEO requires a decision that names the business outcome, data owner, reviewer, measure and stop condition.

Current policies

- BRD-1: External customer commitments require human approval by the service director.
- BRD-2: A board recommendation must distinguish measured pilot results from assumptions.
- BRD-3: Confidential source files may be used only by approved roles; an unexpected Copilot citation triggers an access review.
- BRD-4: Unresolved high-impact safety failures require a hold decision.

Case facts

NS-01 - Transformation ambition

- Business input: A service division misses response targets
- Expected decision artifact: One-page transformation mandate
- Named review gate: CEO approves a measurable business problem
- Challenge to test: Ambition is only a technology slogan
- Outcome measure: Target service-cycle reduction

NS-02 - Value pool map

- Business input: Five departments and task-volume estimates
- Expected decision artifact: Value pool map with owner
- Named review gate: Keep only opportunities tied to a named outcome
- Challenge to test: High-volume activity has no customer value
- Outcome measure: Annual addressable hours by pool

NS-03 - Executive sponsor

- Business input: Four competing leadership priorities
- Expected decision artifact: Sponsor decision and named accountable owner
- Named review gate: Sponsor commits a review cadence
- Challenge to test: No executive owns the benefit
- Outcome measure: Sponsor decisions closed on time

NS-04 - Stakeholder alignment

- Business input: Sales, service, finance and risk concerns
- Expected decision artifact: Stakeholder trade-off matrix
- Named review gate: Record dissent before selecting a pilot
- Challenge to test: Risk concern is omitted from the brief
- Outcome measure: Unresolved stakeholder objections

NS-05 - Success definition

- Business input: Baseline cycle time and quality scores
- Expected decision artifact: Outcome scorecard with baseline and target
- Named review gate: Board accepts denominator and time window
- Challenge to test: Activity count is presented as impact
- Outcome measure: Target met on comparable work